THE GUIDE

Vibe Code Studio

Raw talking-head footage in. Captioned vertical clips and on-brand covers out. On your own machine, inside Claude Code.

Working name - not finalized · Private test guide



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I run an AI-native growth firm. I build with AI in public, and this kit is the exact setup behind how I edit and package my videos.

Where it lives

Private repository: **https://github.com/EthanHalf/vibe-code-studio** — visible only to you. Clone it with your own GitHub login:

```
git clone https://github.com/EthanHalf/vibe-code-studio.git
cd vibe-code-studio
./setup.sh
```

Then open the folder in Claude Code and say: **Set up Vibe Code Studio for me.** The assistant walks you through keys, brand, and a sample run. (A separate file, `ONBOARDING.md`, carries the step-by-step instructions your coding assistant follows.)

The two things it does

1. Caption a clip - free and offline. Local Whisper on your machine; no account, no API key, nothing uploaded:

```
bin/caption-local take.mp4 take_captioned.mp4 --preset brand/presets/captions-phrase.json
```

2. Make covers. A photo or a frame from your video plus a headline becomes a YouTube thumbnail (1280x720) and a vertical cover (1080x1920) in your brand, with platform safe zones handled:

```
python3 skills/thumbnail/scripts/thumb.py make --image frame.png \
    --headline "CLAUDE EDITS MY VIDEOS" --accent EDITS \
    --preset brand/presets/vibe-code-ceo.json --outdir covers/
```

What it costs, and where your data goes

The kit itself is free and open source (MIT). The honest picture:

- **Local captioning (the default above):** runs entirely on your machine. Your footage and audio are not uploaded anywhere. First run downloads the Whisper model (~460 MB) from a public model repository.
- **Cover background removal (`--cutout`):** also fully local; first run downloads the rembg model (~176 MB).
- **Claude Code:** the assistant that drives the kit processes your footage details, transcripts, and instructions under your own Claude plan and its terms - the one service that sees your content on the local path.
- **AssemblyAI (optional):** the upstream editor's default transcription service. If you choose it, your audio is uploaded to AssemblyAI and billed per minute on your own key. Not required for the local path above.
- **Anything else the full editor connects** (Google Drive ingest, posting tools) stays off until you connect it yourself during onboarding.

What is tested, and what is not

Tested (on Linux, in this project's build environment):

- The offline caption chain above, end to end on a sample clip, including a caption-vs-audio sync check that passed with 0 mismatches.
- The cover builder, including background removal on a real photo, both brand presets, and both output sizes, with rendered results inspected.

Not yet tested:

- The full `/edit` workflow (silence cutting, face-tracking reframe, end card). It runs inside Claude Code on your machine and needs a first real run on your Mac before you rely on it.
- A clean install on a fresh Mac. Treat your first `./setup.sh` run as the real install test; the health check (`doctor.py`) names anything missing and the exact command to fix it.

Make it yours

Your brand is a preset file: colors, font, accent. Copy `brand/presets/default.json`, change it, pass it with `--preset`. The `vibe-code-ceo` preset (black, white, gold #FFD60A, Montserrat ExtraBold) ships as a worked example.

Built on the open-source Vibe Editing plugin (MIT) - see `NOTICE.md`. Bundled fonts are SIL Open Font License. Originals are never modified: the kit reads your footage and writes new files to an output folder you choose.